Syllabus for Cultural Anthropology

Welcome to AN310: Cultural Anthropology!

Please read the information on this page before proceeding to the course materials.

Credits: 3 semester credit hours

Prerequisite: None

Textbook

Miller, B. D. (2017). *Cultural Anthropology* (8th Ed.). Boston, MA: Pearson.

Course Description

AN310, Cultural Anthropology, introduces the student to basic concepts and understandings related to the study of human cultures. A student who completes this course will be able to describe the evolution of our species from extinct hominid ancestors, explain approaches to researching diverse cultures and discuss a wide range of topics, including distinct modes of livelihood, the nature and structure of social groups, the central importance of language in human life worlds, the varieties of kinship systems, the impacts of technology, and the cross-cultural dynamics resulting from globalization.

Course Overview

This course is composed of 8 individual lessons, each covering one or more chapters in the textbook. An exam is given at the end of each lesson. A proctored, comprehensive semester exam is given at the conclusion of the semester. Students must earn a score of at least 70 percent in no more than two attempts on the proctored final exam. New questions are given for the second attempt. The final percentile grade is the average of the scores earned on each exam. Letter grades are based on a scale of A – 90 to 100; B – 80 to 89; C – 70 to 79; D – 60 to 69, and F – 59 or below.

Course Learning Objectives

Upon completion of this course, you will be able to:

- Assess the study of culture in relationship to our increasing understanding of the evolution of our species.
- Compare the different approaches to researching culture in light of the five basic economic modes of production, ranging from foraging to industrialism.
- Compare cross-cultural concepts of consumption and exchange and how the modes of production are related: fertility and mortality, fertility control, and processes of socialization over the life cycle.
- Analyze the scope of ethnomedicine in relationship to disease, illness, and healing, as well as varying kinship systems and domestic patterns in different kinds of cultures.
- Summarize social stratification as a hierarchical ordering of statuses, including the ways by which anthropologists differentiate power, authority, and influence in the context of political organization and leadership.
- Explain the importance and role of language (verbal, written, and gestural) and major religions to our existence as a social species.

- Describe the importance of the different kinds of art as expressions of cultural norms, beliefs, and values.
- Describe the different motivations and categories of migration and the ways by which indigenous peoples and women are redefining development.

Course Schedule and Topics

The following lesson plan is recommended for students working on AN310: Cultural Anthropology:

Week	Read/Submit	Topics
Week 1	Chapters 1 and 2 Online Exam	Culture and Human Evolution
Week 2	Chapters 3 and 4 Online Exam	Research Culture and Making a Living
Week 3	Chapters 5 and 6 Online Exam	Consumption, Exchange, Reproduction, and Human Development
Week 4	Chapters 7 and 8 Assignment	Disease, Illness, Kinship, and Domestic Life
Week 5	Chapters 9 and 10 Online Exam	Social Groups, Stratification, Power and Politics
Week 6	Chapters 11 and 12	Communication and Religion
Week 7	Chapter 13 Online Exam	Expressive Culture
Week 8	Chapters 14 and 15 Online Exam Assignment	Human Migration and Defining Development

Course Format

This course is divided into eight Lessons. Study these lessons in the same order as they appear in the Course Outline. Strive to complete all assigned readings and course requirements for each week. Study any supplemental resources provided to acquire a greater depth of understanding of the subject matter.
The Course Home contains useful tools that should be referred to throughout the course. The Student Handbook, writing tips, and assignment format are located on this page.

Course Requirements

Exams and Assignments

Assessments help students gauge their understanding of the course material through the grading process. There are two types of assessments: exams and assignments. The exams and assignments in a course vary in type and number. The types include multiple-choice, essay writing, and/or short answer. All lesson materials are covered by the assignments and exams. Usually there is one assessment per lesson; however, there may be some exams that cover more than one lesson's material. Please read the course syllabus GRADE WEIGHT section before starting to study to understand the exam and assignment expectations for that course.

- Multiple-Choice Exams
- Assignments
- Semester Exams

Workload Expectations

This is a 3 semester credit course. Students should expect to spend 45 hours of academic engagement and 90 hours of preparation to successfully complete this course. Academic engagement may include, but is not limited to, submitting an academic assignment, listening to class lectures or webinars (synchronous or asynchronous), taking an exam, an interactive tutorial, or computer-assisted instruction; attending a study group that is assigned by the institution; contributing to an academic online discussion; initiating contact with a faculty member to ask a question about the academic subject studied in the course and laboratory work, externship or internship. Preparation is typically homework, such as reading and study time, and completing assignments and projects. Non-participation is characterized by lack of engagement and preparation.

This course is comprised of the following elements contributing to the workload.

	Syllabus (Pages)	Writing Help (pages)	Online Library Instructions (Pages)	Assignment Format (Pages)	Note From Your Instructor (Pages)	Textbook (Pages)	Required Readings - Library	Lecture Notes (Pages)	PowerPoint Presentations	Web Site (Pages)	Multiple-Choice Exam Questions	Writing Assignments
AN310 Cultural Anthropology	3	8	12	1	1	372	16	31	15	0	160	2

Grading

In order to pass the course, each assignment, exam, and threaded discussion posting (if applicable) must be completed. Your grades will be based on the quality of work and level of understanding demonstrated. Students can view their course information including grades, GPA, program information and scheduled courses online in the student portal. Grade reports will indicate the courses taken, credits received, and the grade assigned.

Grade Weight

Your grade in AN310: Cultural Anthropology will be computed from your scores on two (2) Assignments and six (6) Online Exams.

Assessment	Lessons Covered	%
Online Exam	1	10%
Online Exam	2	10%
Online Exam	3	10%
Assignment	4	10%
Online Exam	4 & 5	20%
Online Exam	6 & 7	20%
Online Exam	8	10%
Assignment	8	10%

Grading Policies

Please see the Policies section in this course or the Student Handbook for information on Ashworth's Grading Policy and Ashworth's Exam/Assignment Retake Policy.